

ELIZABETH ODETOKUN, PHRi

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

People and operations leader specializing in building organizational infrastructure, scaling teams, and driving operational effectiveness in high-growth startups, driven by compliance and data-informed decision-making.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led a departmental restructuring initiative that improved role clarity, accelerated execution speed, and strengthened hiring alignment with business growth objectives (Mainstack).
- Scaled company headcount by 50% within 60 days across technical and non-technical functions to support rapid pre-launch expansion (Zap Africa)
- Supported the scaling of a distributed, multi-country workforce from 30 to 65 employees during a period of 500% business growth and expansion to 1M+ active customers (Bundle Africa).
- Built and scaled HR systems, policies, and operational frameworks from zero as a founding People team member across two high-growth startups.
- Launched the company's first Graduate Accelerator Program, creating a sustainable early-career talent pipeline and reducing reliance on external hiring. (Mainstack).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HR & Operations Manager | Mainstack Social Commerce

Nov 2024 – Present

- Serve as the Founders' primary strategic partner, advising on workforce planning, organizational design, performance management, and overall organizational effectiveness.
- Identified structural inefficiencies within the Sales & Operations function and led a departmental restructuring that separated Customer Support from Marketing while redefining the Marketing function into a Growth & Marketing team. This improved role clarity, accelerated team execution, and strengthened hiring alignment with evolving business growth objectives.
- Engineered the performance management framework to incorporate OKR-aligned goals, standardize feedback practices, and strengthen performance visibility; collaborated with the Product team to build a tailored internal performance review tool.
- Identified and mitigated operational risks by reducing knowledge concentration, closing documentation gaps, and eliminating single points of dependency across critical functions.
- Partner with cross-functional teams across Product, Engineering, and Marketing to execute strategic initiatives and support business priorities beyond core HR operations.
- Launched a quarterly company-wide Speaker Series featuring leaders such as Babajide Duroshola and Tricia Biz to drive conversations around ownership and strategic thinking, contributing to lasting shifts in team culture and ways of working.

- Designed and governed a flexible talent framework (contractors, consultants, and freelancers), managing legal classification, contract negotiation, and integrating performance expectations (KPIs and PMP) to ensure compliance and execution quality.
- Present periodic People & Ops insights to founders, enabling data-driven workforce planning and performance interventions.
- Managed complex, sensitive employee relations cases involving high-level disciplinary matters and performance, ensuring fair, compliant outcomes while upholding employee trust and organizational discretion.
- Launched the company's first Graduate Accelerator Program, creating a sustainable early-career talent pipeline and reducing reliance on external hiring.
- Led quarterly engagement initiatives informed by pulse survey insights, improving employee experience and supporting retention efforts.
- Led operations for our flagship event (Moment 2026), managing cross-functional coordination, execution workflows, budget, logistics, and operational planning to ensure successful delivery, bringing together 4,000 creators and multiple high-impact local and international sponsors for the first edition.
- Developed a centralized Learning Repository and HR FAQ hub that improved onboarding efficiency and increased employee self-service adoption through accessible documentation and process guides.

HR Manager | Zap Africa

Aug 2023 – Aug 2024

- Served as founding HR team member: built all HR policies, processes, systems, and compliance frameworks from zero, providing the people infrastructure for sustainable growth.
- Scaled headcount by 50% within 60 days, recruiting across technical and non-technical roles to support rapid expansion — from pre-launch to 2,000+ users in the company's first year.
- Developed a Manager Playbook equipping first-time managers with structured guidance on leadership, feedback, and team performance management.
- Built and maintained a centralized employee data management system, improving workforce visibility and enabling data-informed people decisions.
- Designed employee engagement, performance review, and onboarding frameworks that strengthened cohesion and productivity across a distributed team.
- Managed HR operations for two additional portfolio businesses simultaneously, demonstrating adaptability across multiple organizational contexts.

People Operations Specialist | Bundle Africa

Mar 2022 – Jul 2023

- Supported the growth of a fully remote, multi-country workforce from 30 to 65 employees, enabling the business to scale to 1M+ active customers and achieve 500% growth.
- Managed full-cycle hiring, onboarding, and culture initiatives across a multicultural, distributed workforce, including the LEAD.BOT program to strengthen team cohesion and employee engagement.
- Coordinated an average \$120K monthly operational budget covering salaries, benefits, and software spend, ensuring financial discipline and operational compliance.

- Managed operational tooling and third-party vendor subscriptions, ensuring uninterrupted access, timely lifecycle management, and operational continuity across teams.

HR & Administrative Officer | Sygnite Power & Energy Solutions

Feb 2020 – Feb 2022

- Developed and implemented the Culture of Ownership & Excellence framework, driving measurable improvements in employee motivation and productivity.
- Analyzed exit interview data revealing high turnover due to long commute times and successfully proposed and implemented a hybrid work model after securing management approval, improving employee retention.
- Managed day-to-day HR operations, talent management reporting, and succession planning data to support management decision-making.
- Executed employee engagement initiatives including pulse surveys, exit interview analysis, and team bonding events, generating actionable workforce insights.
- Coordinated cross-departmental communication on HR matters and managed organization-wide events, including strategy sessions and year-end activities.

LEADERSHIP & INDUSTRY ENGAGEMENT

- Mentor five early-career female HR professionals on career development, people operations, and navigating high-growth startup environments.
- Share insights on HR, leadership, and organizational effectiveness across social platforms.
- Developed employee engagement planning resources to support scalable culture-building initiatives, with over 10 copies sold.

TOOLS & HRIS

ClickUp, Notion, Asana, Slack, Google Workspace, Microsoft Excel, Loom, Miro, HRIS Platforms (Bamboo, etc.).

CERTIFICATIONS

PHRi (Professional in Human Resources – International) HR Certification Institute (HRCI)	Jan 2023
HR Reporting Specialist Academy to Innovate HR (AIHR)	July 2022

EDUCATION

MBA Lagos Business School	<i>Expected 2027</i>
Data Analytics Diploma ALX Africa	<i>Sept 2024</i>
B.Sc. Industrial Relations & Personnel Management University of Lagos	<i>Dec 2019</i>